



Between the Pages

A bookmark of six questions that work on any book, for whatever your students are already reading. Hand one to everybody, let them read, then talk about one of the questions. They keep the bookmark, and next time you pick a different question.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	The bookmarks, four to a sheet, on card if you have it. Eight sheets for a form of thirty.
Page 3	Follow-up questions for each one. For you, not for them.

How it works

Step	What happens
1	Print the bookmarks on card and cut them out. Give one to every student to keep in whatever they are reading at the moment: a library book, the class reader, something from home.
2	Let them read, whenever reading already happens: form time, the end of a lesson, at home.
3	Pick one of the six questions and talk about it. Pairs first for a minute, then two or three share with the room. Page 3 has follow-up questions if it goes quiet.
4	Next time, pick a different one. There is no set order. Go back to one that worked, or let the form choose.

Worth knowing

- Each question has a label students already use in English: Character, Setting, Theme, Values, Language and Structure. Saying “Today is Setting” is enough to start.
- Every question works whatever the book is, so two students reading completely different things can still talk about the same one.
- A student who hasn’t read anything that day can still join in with the last book they read.
- Nothing gets written down or marked. It is a conversation, not a comprehension task.
- If your school has a reading scheme, this can be used with it. Adapt it to fit your needs.





The bookmarks

Four to a sheet, printed on card if you can. Each one is sized to fit inside a normal paperback. Cut round the outside of the green line and give one to every student to keep in whatever they are reading.

Name _____

While you read

Six things to think about, whatever the book is.

1 CHARACTER

Which character did you learn the most about today, and what did you learn?

2 SETTING

Where is this part of the book happening, and how does the writer help you picture the place?

3 THEME

What big idea is this book about, like friendship, fear or growing up?

4 VALUES

Did a character do something today that you think was right or wrong?

5 LANGUAGE

Which word or phrase stood out to you today, and why?

6 STRUCTURE

What do you think will happen next, and what clue made you think that?

Keep this in whatever you're reading.

 The Pastoral Guide

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Follow-up questions

For you, not for them. Three more for each question on the bookmark, for when the talk goes quiet.

1 Character	Which character did you learn the most about today, and what did you learn? • What did the character say or do that showed you this? • Has your opinion of this character changed? • Would you want this character as a friend?
2 Setting	Where is this part of the book happening, and how does the writer help you picture the place? • Which words help you picture the place? • How does the place make the characters feel? • Would the story work in a different place?
3 Theme	What big idea is this book about, like friendship, fear or growing up? • Which moment in today's reading showed you this idea? • What does the writer seem to think about this idea? • Does this idea matter in your own life?
4 Values	Did a character do something today that you think was right or wrong? • Why do you think the character made that choice? • What would you have done instead? • Would most people agree with you?
5 Language	Which word or phrase stood out to you today, and why? • What does the word make you think or feel? • What other word could the writer have used? • Why do you think the writer chose this word?
6 Structure	What do you think will happen next, and what clue made you think that? • Did anything in today's reading surprise you? • Is the writer keeping something from you? • What would you like to happen next?

